

lovely Aino than at the thought of his own stupidity, which he feels is increasing with advancing years. If his mother had been alive, he thinks he would have acted more wisely; and the old lady, hearing his complaints in her grave, advises him to seek consolation* by wooing another maiden in the north.

In conformity with his mother's advice, Wäinämöinen sets off for a village in the northland, but is waylaid by Joukahainen, who still harbours his ancient grudge. Shooting at him with a bow of exquisite workmanship, he twice misses him; but the third arrow wounds Wäinämöinen's horse, and the rider falls, to be carried away by a hurricane into the boundless waters. Joukahainen, dooming his enemy to float unceasingly for eight years, returns exulting to his mother; but she hears him disapprovingly, and tells him that he did an ill deed in shooting Wäinämöinen.

After swimming about several days, Wäinämöinen feels the same uneasiness that might befall any ordinary mortal, pondering with himself whether he is most likely to end his days by hunger or by drowning. He is rescued by an eagle, who, still mindful of his benevolence in leaving the birch-tree intact for the repose of the birds, takes him upon his back. His position, however, is not materially improved, as he is placed by the eagle on a remote northern coast, whence he sees no prospect of returning. A beautiful girl hears his lamentations from the opposite coast, and tells what she has heard to Louhi, the "hostess" of Pohjola, as she is called, who, fetching him in a boat, brings him to her own residence, where she hospitably offers to entertain him with boar's flesh and salmon. With such delights he will have nothing to do, but pathetically demands to be taken back to his own country, Kalewala. Louhi promises to comply with his request, if he will make for her a certain machine, called the Sampo. He answers that he is no smith himself, but undertakes to send an able craftsman, named Ilmarinen; and he is accordingly allowed to depart in a sledge, with the information that the hand of Louhi's daughter will be given to the manufacturer of the Sampo. On his way homeward the maiden of Pohjola is sitting on a rainbow, weaving a web of gold and silver. He invites her to descend into the sledge, and go home with him as his bride, which she refuses to do if he will not perform a number of seemingly impossible tasks—peel skins from a stone, split a horse-hair with a knife, and so on. All these tasks he executes with facility till he comes to the manufacture of a sea-worthy boat without the employment of his hands or feet. An axe, guided by the malignant deity Lempo, wounds him in the foot while he is engaged in his work, and whole fields are covered with the blood which issues from the wound. In order to be healed, he enters the hut of an old man, to whom he describes, in a myth which we pass over with regret, the origin of iron, and its perversion from harmless to mischievous purposes. The blood is stopped by the force of

* This incident is not to be reconciled with the miraculous birth of the sage; but the authenticity of the first Rune is doubtful.—J. O.